

CONTACT

- Berlin, Germany
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- theleadershipfork.com
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- Google Scholar profile

EXPERTISE

- Leadership & team culture
- Coaching leaders and managers
- Leading cross-functional tech teams (engineering, science, product)
- Leading remote, multi-site teams
- Building & scaling teams
- Computer vision & AI/ML
- Turning research into products
- AI strategy & roadmaps
- Technical due diligence

EDUCATION

M.Sc. and Ph.D. in Computer Vision

Graz University of Technology | 1996 – 2007

Both with highest distinction

RESEARCH RECORD

50+	peer-reviewed papers
26	at the big five venues
	CVPR, ICCV, ECCV, BMVC, ACCV
3,310	citations
27	h-index

LANGUAGES

German (native) | English (fluent)

Michael Donoser, Ph.D.

Author · Leadership Coach · Former Director of Science, Amazon

PROFILE

Leader of science and AI teams who has worked on both sides of innovation. First a computer vision researcher, from Ph.D. to a tenured position at Graz University of Technology with 50+ peer-reviewed papers, then twelve years at Amazon turning research into products: from founding the computer vision team in Berlin to leading a cross-functional AI organization as Director of Science, with 20+ launches and customer impact in the billions of dollars. Now writing *The Leadership Fork* and coaching leaders on the habits that let smart people and their teams thrive.

EXPERIENCE

Author & Leadership Coach
2026 - today

Independent, Berlin

- Writing *The Leadership Fork: 55 Mechanisms for Leading When the Playbook Stops Working*, coming in 2027
- Biweekly newsletter on leadership and team culture
- Coaching leaders in tech on the habits that help teams thrive

Director of Science
2023 - 2026

Amazon, Germany

- Led a cross-functional computer vision and AI innovation organization of up to 40 software engineers, scientists and product managers across several German sites; manager of managers, reporting to a Retail VP in the US
- Set long-term CV & AI strategy and roadmap as a central team serving businesses worldwide, including Prime Video, Alexa, Pharmacy, Amazon Fresh and Retail
- 20+ production launches with customer impact in the billions of dollars: image & video generation and moderation, visual recommendations, image translation, shoppable images, virtual try-on, video copyright infringement detection, video maturity recognition, accessibility on Echo screen devices
- Technical due diligence for multiple acquisitions
- Founded the *Leadership Awareness* development program on emotional intelligence in fast-paced environments
- 200+ recruiting interviews at Amazon as hiring manager and interviewer

Senior Applied Scientist Manager
2018 - 2023

Amazon, Germany

- Grew the team beyond Berlin to further sites in Tübingen and Munich
- Grew its research to production pipelines across multiple Amazon product lines

Applied Scientist Manager
2014 - 2018

Amazon, Berlin

- Founded and built the computer vision science team in Berlin, from the first hire to its culture

Assistant Professor, then tenured Senior Researcher
2008 - 2014

Institute for Computer Graphics and Vision, Graz University of Technology

- Led the Virtual Habitat research group and supervised eight Ph.D. students

AWARDS

Best Paper Award Asian Conference on Computer Vision (ACCV) 2012

Best Paper Award (twice) Austrian Association for Pattern Recognition (OAGM) 2009, 2010

Best Paper Award International Conference on Pattern Recognition (ICPR) 2008

Josef Krainer Prize State of Styria, for early career scientific achievement 2008